



U.S. POLITICS won't stop Tijuana's La Casita de Union Trans, above, from trying to support trans women, the shelter's director said. Photographs by GENARO MOLINA Los Angeles Times

Migrants ponder their next moves

As U.S. spurns would-be asylum seekers, some in Tijuana say they might attempt to enter illegally

By ANDREA CASTILLO

TIJUANA — When the Russian man arrived at the U.S.-Mexico border on March 1, he knew he was too late. Still, he held onto hope that even with President Trump in office he could be let into the United States to seek asylum.

Slavik, a 37-year-old engineer, said he fled Russia after being beaten by security forces



A HEALTH clinic's closure has increased pressure on midwife Ximena Rojas, right, with colleague Xanic Zamudio, to expand its services.

for supporting the opposing political party. He had hoped to meet U.S. immigration officials to apply for asylum, he said, and has friends willing to sponsor him.

Instead, he spent weeks at a shelter for migrants in Tijuana as he mulled over what to do next.

"I just tried to do by rules and wait," said Slavik, who asked to be identified by his nickname for fear of retribution. "There is nothing else now. All immigration will be illegally."

In Tijuana, thousands of migrants such as Slavik had tried to secure an appointment with immigration officials through a Biden administration phone application, but President Trump canceled the program, in effect blocking access to asylum. Many have since left the region.

[See Mexico, A4]

Offices get new lease serving students

Thousands from Pacific Palisades give a lift to Santa Monica real estate market.

By DANIEL MILLER AND ROGER VINCENT

Light jazz played from unseen speakers in a grassy landscape ribboned with walkways and dotted with drought-tolerant shrubbery. The idyll was hemmed in by immaculate office buildings housing high-profile Hollywood and tech tenants including Amazon, Oracle and AMC Networks.

Down by the lawn, some of the newest occupants at the Santa Monica complex, called the Water Garden, reclined in Adirondack chairs with books in hand.

Class was in session at Calvary Christian School.

It's one of five schools from the Pacific Palisades area that has relocated to Santa Monica office properties — or will soon do so — in the aftermath of the January inferno that destroyed nearly 7,000 structures and burned more than 23,000 acres.

Thousands of K-12 students will inhabit more than 200,000 square feet of space, positioning schools as an un-

[See Students, A6]

The health harms of EPA rollbacks

President's cutting of environmental rules will cause many early deaths, watchdogs say.

By HAYLEY SMITH

The Trump administration's slash-and-burn approach to federal programs has delivered a considerable hit to the nation's environ-

ment, but experts say its plans to repeal hard-won protections for clean air and water will also directly jeopardize Americans' health — and their wallets.

Two new reports from environmental watchdog groups outline how the administration's recent regulatory rollbacks, cuts to climate programs and promotion of fossil fuel production will significantly increase the cost of living for millions

of people and bring about hundreds of thousands of premature deaths.

That's in contradiction to the claims made by President Trump and his allies — including Elon Musk and Environmental Protection Agency Administrator Lee Zeldin — that they are gutting the nation's climate programs in an effort to ease regulatory costs, lower taxes and "power the great American comeback."

Instead, the rollback of some of the nation's key environmental safeguards could lead to nearly 200,000 additional premature deaths in the next 25 years; cause more than 10,000 extra asthma attacks each day; and cost the public six dollars for every dollar supposedly saved by regulated industries, according to a recent analysis from the Environmental Protection

[See Rollbacks, A8]

Signs of life for SoCal's midcentury motels

Rather than go luxe or disappear, some have become community hubs



THE FARM HOUSE Collective's opening day in March drew visitors to the Riverside site that includes a 1950s motel, a mini-mall, a food hall and a music venue.

By CHRISTOPHER REYNOLDS

There were no vacancies beneath the old neon Farm House Motel sign on a recent Saturday — no guest rooms at all, in fact. But the 1950s Riverside property, now known as the Farm House Collective, was busier than it has been for decades.

By 10 a.m., when a ribbon-cutting marked the Farm House's rebirth as a mini-mall, food hall and music venue, the parking lot was full.

By midday, Steve Elliott of Smokey Steve's barbecue had sold about 160 pounds of meat from his pop-up booth and there was a long line for \$6 tacos at Bar Ni Modo.

By sundown, an audience of several hundred had gathered

[See Motels, A9]

Newsom pushing plans for Delta tunnel

Governor wants to lay groundwork for the \$20-billion, 45-mile water project before his term expires.

By IAN JAMES

The battle over whether California should build a \$20-billion water tunnel in the Sacramento-San Joaquin River Delta is escalating, with Gov. Gavin Newsom pushing to lay the groundwork for the project before his term expires and state water regulators considering whether to grant a key authorization.

The State Water Resources Control Board has begun holding a series of hearings on a petition by the Newsom administration to amend water rights permits so that flows could be diverted from new points on the Sacramento River where the intakes of the 45-mile tunnel would be built.

The process has grown tense in recent weeks, as the Newsom administration and water agencies have pushed back against how the board's officials are handling parts of the process, and as opponents have urged the board not to bend to political pressure.

Speaking at a virtual hearing Thursday, state Department of Water Resources general counsel Ann Carroll presented the Newsom administration's case for the tunnel, calling it one of California's "most important climate adaptation projects."

"Changing precipitation patterns are leading to more rain, less snow and a limited ability to capture and move water," Carroll said. "The ability to capture high flows when available is critical to adapting to a changing climate."

Supporters of the plan, called the Delta Conveyance Project, say the state urgently needs to build new infrastructure in the Delta to protect the water supply in the face of climate change

[See Tunnel, A6]

A second child dies of measles

Health Secretary Kennedy visits the families of both unvaccinated victims in west Texas. NATION, A5

National parks told to stay open

The Trump administration orders all the sites to remain open despite staff cuts. CALIFORNIA, B1

A Pasadena theater's win

Pasadena Playhouse regains ownership of its landmark building as it marks 100 years. ENTERTAINMENT, E1

Weather

Mostly sunny. L.A. Basin: 76/53. B5

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